

028. Chapter 3 Verses 4-6

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.4

न कर्मणामनारम्भान्नैष्कर्म्यं पुरुषोऽश्नुते ।
न च संन्यसनादेव सिद्धिं समधिगच्छति ॥ ४ ॥

na karmaṇāmanārambhān
naiṣkarmyaṃ puruṣo'śnute |
na ca sannyasanādeva
siddhiṃ samadhigacchati ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **karmaṇām** – of actions; **anārambhāt** – from non-performance;
- ◆ **naiṣkarmyam** – freedom from action; **puruṣaḥ** – a man; **aśnute** – attains;
- ◆ **na** – not; **ca** – and; **sannyasanāt** – from renunciation; **eva** – only;
- ◆ **siddhim** – perfection; **samadhigacchati** – attains.

Man does not match the actionless state of Brahman by mere non-performance of work, nor does he attain perfection by renunciation only.

VERSE 3.5

न हि कश्चित्क्षणमपि जातु तिष्ठत्यकर्मकृत् ।
कार्यते ह्यवशः कर्म सर्वः प्रकृतिजैर्गुणैः ॥ ५ ॥

na hi kaścitkṣaṇamapi
jātu tiṣṭhatyakarmakṛt |
kāryate hyavaśaḥ karma
sarvaḥ prakṛtijairguṇaiḥ ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **hi** – indeed; **kaścit** – anyone; **kṣaṇam** – a moment; **api** – even;
- ◆ **jātu** – ever; **tiṣṭhati** – remains; **akarma-kṛt** – without performing action;
- ◆ **kāryate** – is made to do; **hi** – for; **avaśaḥ** – helplessly; **karma** – action;
- ◆ **sarvaḥ** – everyone; **prakṛti-jaiḥ** – born of nature; **guṇaiḥ** – by the Gunas (modes).

No one can live even for a moment without doing work.

Everyone without his will is made to do work by the qualities born of Prakriti.

VERSE 3.6

कर्मेन्द्रियाणि संयम्य य आस्ते मनसा स्मरन् ।
इन्द्रियार्थान्विमूढात्मा मिथ्याचारः स उच्यते ॥ ६ ॥

karmendriyāṇi saṁyamya
ya āste manasā smaran |
indriyārthānvimūḍhātmā
mithyācāraḥ sa ucyate ||

- ◆ **karma-indriyāṇi** – the organs of action; **saṁyamya** – restraining;
- ◆ **yaḥ** – who; **āste** – sits; **manasā** – with the mind; **smaran** – dwelling upon;
- ◆ **indriya-arthān** – objects of the senses; **vimūḍha-ātmā** – of deluded soul;
- ◆ **mithyā-ācāraḥ** – hypocrite; **saḥ** – he; **ucyate** – is called.

The man of deluded understanding who restraining the organs of the action sits contemplating the sense objects with the mind is called a hypocrite.